MS-203 – Microsoft 365 Messaging Change Log

July 2020

Purpose

The purpose of this document is to highlight the significant changes to the MS-203T00-A course from the previous release. This document is for Microsoft Certified Trainers and Instructors to review before they deliver the class or during preparation for teaching the class.

This is not an error log or a supplement to the Course Materials. This document simply provides additional context so that you can understand the major changes to the course content. The course materials in the MCT Download Center have also been updated to fix typos, broken links, and formatting, so we recommend you always download the latest copies.

✔ Please read the Trainer Preparation Guide which provides the overall strategy for implementing this training.

The Evolution of Microsoft 365 Messaging (MS-203T00)

Although this is a new course, MS-203 is actually a conglomeration of the three MS-200.x courses and the two MS-201.x courses. Those courses were each basically 1-1 ½ day courses, and we combined them all together into this one, 5-day course.

Before doing so, we conducted a Job Task Analysis (JTA) of the Messaging Admin role to determine the key messaging administration tasks that needed to be covered in both training and certification. The JTA confirmed the majority of existing MS-200.x and 201.x content was still valid and should be retained in the new MS-203 course and exam. However, there was one major change that came about from the JTA; specifically, we eliminated the content related to Microsoft Exchange Server 2019 unless it specifically related to a hybrid environment. The content that was removed will be used for a course TBD at a later date. The focus of this new MS-203 course is on cloud and hybrid solutions for Enterprise customers.

The MS-203 course has been aligned to the new MS-203 certification exam, which replaces the existing MS-200 and 201 exams. Just as the MS-200 and 201 courses have been consolidated into one course (MS-203), so too have the MS-200 and 201 exams been consolidated into one exam (MS-203). The consolidation of the exams and courses was due to the elimination of

several objectives that were found solely related to on-premises Exchange Server 2019 environments. The intent of removing the on-premises material is not to eliminate training for Exchange Server 2019, but to refocus the Messaging Administrator role by aligning it to the future of the modern workplace. It is Microsoft's mission to empower every person and every organization around the globe to achieve more, and with this new alignment we hope to do just that.

Change Log

While combining all the MS-200.x and 201.x courses into MS-203, we made the following changes:

1. The following modules from the MS-200.x and 201.x courses were **NOT** included in MS-203:

Module Name	Course Number	Module Number
Managing Modern Messaging Infrastructure	MS-200.1	1
Managing Mailbox Databases	MS-200.1	3
Managing Client Access	MS-200.2	1
High Availability for Exchange Servers	MS-200.3	1
Managing Disaster Recovery	MS-200.3	2

2. The content from the existing courses were not inserted into MS-203 in the sequential order in which they appeared in MS-200.x through MS-201.x. Instead, they were inserted based on the following topic flow as per the JTA recommendation:
    - Message transport
    - Mail flow
    - Message hygiene and compliance
    - Organizational settings
    - Mobile devices
    - Role-based permissions
    - Recipient objects and resources
    - Public folders
    - Planning hybrid deployments

- Mailbox migrations
- Implementing hybrid deployments

3. Since Module 11 (Performing Mailbox Migrations) does not have an actual hands-on lab, and given the lengthy nature of the lecture topics in this module, we added a paper-based planning exercise at the end of the module to help keep students engaged in the content.

   In this paper-based lab, students take on the role of the Messaging Admin for the fictitious Fabrikam Corporation. They are asked to review the company's IT footprint and then answer a series of questions from Fabrikam management related to migrating on-premises mailboxes to Microsoft 365 as part of its mail migration pilot project.

   In this exercise, each student should exchange his or her assessment with a fellow student and review each other's assessment. You should conclude this exercise by reviewing the assessments with the class and coming to a final consensus for Fabrikam.

   A trainer version of the assessment document is available on the MCT Download folder along with this Change Log and the Trainer Prep Guide. This trainer version has suggested answers for each question. Please refer to the Trainer Prep Guide for instruction on how to use this trainer version of the assessment document in this exercise.
4. In the existing lab in module 2, we added a new task to create a mail flow rule that restricts email size.
5. In module 4 (Managing Compliance), we added a new lab on managing messaging compliance.
6. In the existing lab in module 7, we updated the existing task on creating an OWA policy, and we added a new task to assign the OWA policy you created in the prior task to a user mailbox.
7. In module 12, we added a Final Assessment lab as the last activity in the course. The purpose of this lab is to have the students complete a lab activity on their own, without any step-by-step lab instruction. This lab builds off the prior hybrid labs the students just completed. In those labs, the email being sent by Allan Yoo to Alex Wilber is delivered to Alex's Junk Email folder rather than to his Inbox. In this final assessment lab, the students are asked to troubleshoot this problem using the information they have learned throughout the course.

   We do provide a step-by-step solution guide in case students are unable to solve the

problem on their own. This solution guide is provided in a pdf document rather than as normal instruction in the VM environment. The student manual provides a link that students can select to download the solution guide.

As an instructor, you are asked to encourage students to try solving the problem on their own rather than simply downloading the pdf solution and following its instruction (this is covered is greater detail in the Trainer Prep Guide).

8. At the end of each module, we added a discussion question slide that has 2 questions: 1) What are your key takeaways from this module, and why? and 2) What are the key features discussed in this module that you foresee implementing at your organization?

   These discussion questions were included to get the students more actively involved in the course, and specifically to think about the content from each module and discuss what they learned and whether they can implement it.

9. At the end of each module are 10-15 module review questions that students can use as a knowledge check exercise. While the MS-200 and 201 courses had these same questions, the manner in which the questions are presented has changed. Instead of simply listing all the answers to each question at the bottom of the page as we had done in the past, Skillpipe now provides an automated version of the module questions that enables students to click on a Check Answers button after each question to see whether their answer(s) are correct.

   Important: When you discuss the Module Review questions with the students in the Module Review slide in Module 0, you should inform them of this change. **But more importantly, you should describe for them how to determine whether the answers are correct or incorrect.** Skillpipe does NOT simply say whether they got the question right or wrong, nor does it use text to tell the student if they got a particular answer correct or not. Instead, Skillpipe uses colors to indicate how the student did.

   - If the student answered a question incorrectly, the color of the question will change to red. If they answer the question correctly, the color of the question will change to green (although it's not a bright green, so you have to really look for it).
   - If a selected answer was correct, the answer will change to green (again, not a bright green). If a selected answer was incorrect, it is NOT changed to red; instead, the answer remains black. So incorrect questions are changed to red, but incorrect answers are left black. Differentiating between black and green answers can be a challenge, so remind students to look closely at the color.

10. We updated any product features that changed since the last release of the courseware.
11. In the lab instruction, we performed a complete review and test of every lab task to ensure that the lab steps were current with the product UI at the time of course release.
12. Microsoft 365 has undergone several branding changes over the past few months:
    - Office 365 ProPlus was originally changed to Office 365 Apps and has now been changed to Microsoft 365 Apps for enterprise. While we have updated the content to refer to it as Microsoft 365 Apps for enterprise, the download center site still refers to it as Office 365 Apps, so you may want to call this out to students in the event they want to install it in their real-world environments.
    - The System Center Configuration Manager has been rebranded to the Endpoint Configuration Manager.
    - Office 365 Groups have been rebranded to Microsoft 365 Groups. However, the Microsoft 365 admin center still refers to these as Office 365 groups, so you will need to call this out to students to avoid any confusion.

Note: While we were as thorough as possible in reviewing the content to make these branding changes, there is always the chance that we may have missed something. If you notice any of these items using the old branding rather than the new, or if you know of any other rebranding issue that we may have missed, please report it to Microsoft Support so that we can fix it. Your assistance in this matter is greatly appreciated in helping us keep the content as up to date as possible in this ever-changing cloud world.